The visualiser

Discussing and improving student work

Use the visualiser to make student work a shared learning resource. Select a response because it illustrates a useful success, misconception or improvement decision.

How to do it well

1 Select the response. Choose a useful exemplar or near-miss and identify the learning feature it will reveal.

2 Prepare the display. Check readability, crop or mask irrelevant details and frame the sharing respectfully.

3 Ask students to inspect. Give silent time and a specific question about the criterion before taking contributions.

4 Model improvement. Annotate or edit the relevant section live, explaining the effect of each important change.

5 Require transfer. Students apply the same criterion to their own work or a fresh example, then you sample the resulting improvement.

What this sounds like

“This paragraph gives a clear claim. Let us find where the explanation stops short. We will improve that link, then you will inspect the same feature in your own paragraph.”

Classroom example. A teacher projects an anonymised paragraph that has a strong claim but a weak explanation. Pupils inspect the criterion, then watch a live edit and explain why it improves the link. Everyone makes an equivalent improvement in their own response. The projected work creates shared learning rather than a public judgement of its author.

Top tips that make the technique work

Select with a purpose. Decide which feature the class should notice before projecting the work.

Establish a respectful culture. Sharing should feel routine; anonymise where useful and avoid public embarrassment.

Keep the discussion narrow. One paragraph, diagram or process step often produces a clearer learning focus than the whole page.

Show the edit live. Explain why the change improves the response, retaining successful features.

Transfer to students’ own work. Everyone should make an equivalent improvement rather than merely watch the projected edit.

Do and avoid

Do	Avoid
Make the criterion and revision visible.	Displaying work solely to celebrate presentation.
Use contrasting responses to clarify quality.	Critiquing a named pupil rather than the response.

Further reading

Practitioner guidance; teacher language above is an illustrative BSCS adaptation.

DistillED - The Visualiser The Complete Guide | DistillED - Whole Class Feedback